

Tâche 3 — Step-by-step guide to a successful B2 performance

The complete playbook: what happens on exam day (the ~5 minutes themselves), and what “B2” actually requires. Based on structure-type.md, ../../AMELIORATIONS.md and the corpus analysis in sujets-par-frequence.md.

The format (so you train for the right thing)

Tâche 3 = the examiner reads you a statement/question (e.g. « *Vivre dans un pays étranger est difficile. Êtes-vous d'accord ?* »). **No preparation time.** You speak ~4 min 30 continuously — it is a **monologue** (the back-and-forth of Tâches 1 & 2 isn't part of it). An examiner may interrupt only if your discourse isn't clear.

Score targets: B2 = 10/20 on the global Expression Orale score (NCLC 7); 12/20 = NCLC 8; 14/20 crosses into C1/NCLC 9.

Step by step during the task

Step 0 — First 10–15 seconds (while you start talking, not before)

1. Pick the side that's **easiest to argue**, not your real opinion.
2. Mentally grab **2–3 arguments + 1 concrete example each**.
3. Launch a ready-made opener immediately — it buys your brain time: >
« À mon avis, c'est un sujet très actuel / qui divise l'opinion publique. Personnellement, je pense que... »

Step 1 — Introduction (~30 s)

Rephrase the topic in your own words + announce your position. Never repeat the prompt word-for-word.

Then **announce your plan** — a reliable, works-for-every-subject closer to the intro that scores under the Coherence criterion and buys thinking time:

« **Pour justifier mon opinion, je vous donnerai quelques arguments, suivis de quelques exemples.** »

(futur simple: « donnerai » — careful not to write/say the conditional « donnerais »)

Vary the wording occasionally (e.g. « Je vais vous présenter les avantages, puis les limites, et enfin donner ma conclusion ») so it doesn't sound recited.

Step 2 — Argument 1 (~1 min)

Always the same 4-beat pattern: **idea** → **explanation** → **example** → **mini-conclusion**.

« **Tout d'abord, ... En effet, ... Par exemple, ... C'est pourquoi...** »

The example is what raises your score — take it from your life, your country, or society in general.

Step 3 — Argument 2 (~1 min)

« **Ensuite, ... Cela permet de... C'est notamment le cas de...** »

If you still have time, add a third argument with « **Par ailleurs...** ».

Step 4 — The concession (~45 s) — this is THE B2 move

Acknowledge the opposite view, then push back:

« **Cependant**, certaines personnes pensent que... **Je comprends ce point de vue, mais** je crois que... »

or the stronger pivot:

« **Certes..., il n'en reste pas moins que...** »

Visible nuance is the single clearest B2→C1 differentiator. **Never skip it.**

Step 5 — Conclusion (~30 s)

« **En conclusion**, je pense que..., **car...** »

Optional opening at the end: « On pourrait même se demander si... »

Step 6 — If the examiner reacts

Tâche 3 is a monologue — plan to fill the full 4 min 30 yourself. There's no routine relance, **but an examiner may interrupt to ask a question if your discourse isn't clear** — treat that as a sign to be clearer, answer briefly, and resume. Don't count on interruptions to use up time.

What the graders score (and your countermeasure for each)

Criterion	What gets you B2
Lexical range	Precise theme vocabulary, complex sentences (relatives, subordinates) — not <i>chose/faire/beaucoup</i>
Grammar	Reliable tenses and agreements; correct subjonctif after « bien que », « il faut que »
Fluency	Even tempo for 4½ min, no long silences — one short « euh » is fine, no « euh » chains
Coherence	Connectors beyond <i>et/mais</i> : <i>tout d'abord, en effet, cependant, en conclusion</i>
Interaction	Mostly judged on Tâches 1–2; in Tâche 3, just stay composed if the examiner reacts
Pronunciation	Intonation that supports meaning (secondary at B2)

The 7 day-of-exam reflexes

1. Pick the easiest side to defend.
 2. One concrete example per argument, always.
 3. Connect everything with connectors.
 4. Slip in one concession — the B2 marker.
 5. Two well-developed arguments beat four shallow ones.
 6. **Speak until the end** — silence costs more than errors.
 7. Accept mistakes; fluency and clarity outweigh grammatical perfection.
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How to train between now and the exam

1. **Memorize the express template** in [structure-type.md](#) until it's automatic — it works for ~every topic.
2. **Cover the top 6 themes** (Immigration, Travail, Éducation, Santé, Médias, Technologie = ~78 % of all prompts) with 5–8 « → » collocations each from [../vocabulaire/vocabulaire-par-theme.md](#).
3. **Drill the most recurrent subjects** first — « Vivre dans un pays étranger est difficile » is the #1 prompt in the whole corpus.
4. **Practice the real format:** /tcf-pratique examen — random subject, zero prep, 4 min 30 timed, then feedback. Do 2–3 of these per week.
5. **Read the 5 model answers** in [exemples.md](#) aloud to internalize the rhythm — imitate, don't memorize.

The key insight: since there's no prep time, the skill you're really training is **sustaining structured speech for 4½ minutes on autopilot**. The template + pre-loaded examples are what make that possible.